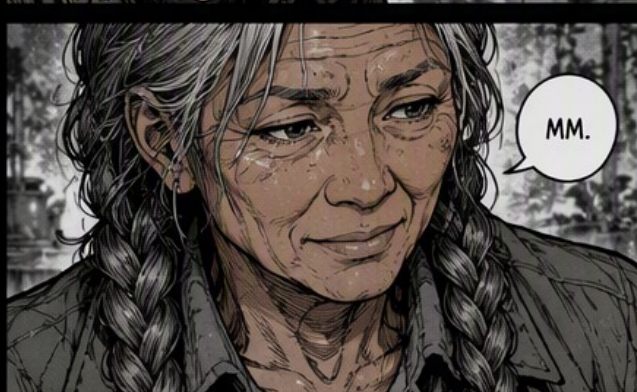
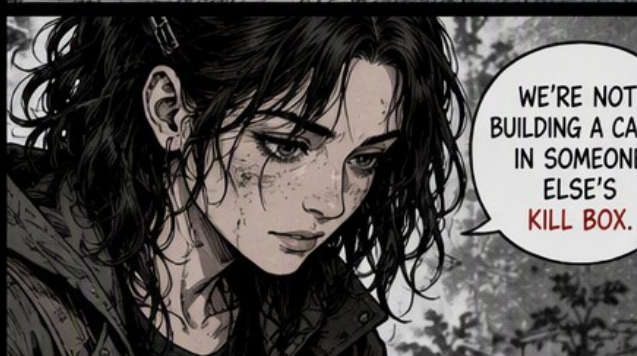


RED LATITUDE

EPISODE 4: THE ISLAND REFUGE





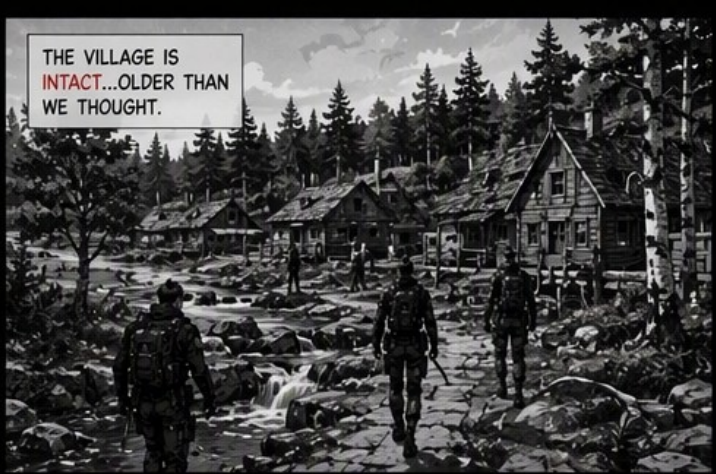


APOSTLE ISLANDS, LAKE SUPERIOR.
GREENLINE SCOUTING MISSION.



GREENLINE
WE DON'T CLEAR PATHS.
WE READ THEM.





THE VILLAGE IS
INTACT...OLDER THAN
WE THOUGHT.



...IT'S BEAUTIFUL.



ABANDONED...
BUT **NOT** BROKEN.



WE TAKE WHAT
WE NEED.



WE LEAVE
WHAT WE DON'T.



THIS PLACE
DESERVES THAT
MUCH.



ONE WAY **IN**.
ONE WAY **OUT**.

GREENLINE



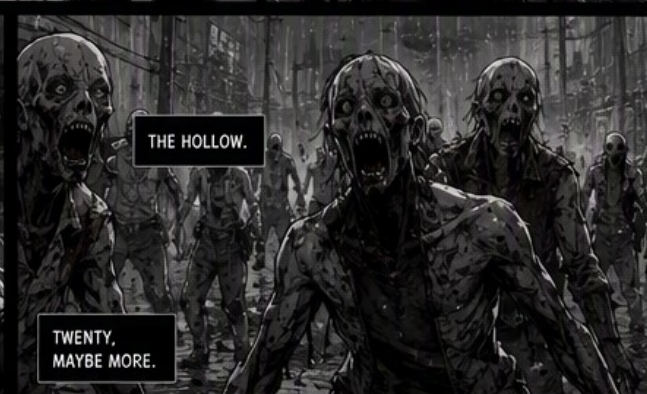
WE DON'T LEAVE MARKS.
WE LEAVE ANSWERS.



NO GUNS.
NO NOISE.



JUST US.



THE HOLLOW.

TWENTY,
MAYBE MORE.



THEY MOVE
LIKE DEAD
THINGS.

WE MOVE
LIKE
PREDATORS.



ONE
JOINT.
ONE
MOVE.
ONE
LESS.



ELEGANCE
IS
EFFICIENCY.



TIGHT
WEDGE.
CLEAN
KILLS.

NO GUNS.
NO
ALERTS.



WE DON'T
HUNT FOR
GLORY.

WE HUNT
SO OTHERS
SURVIVE.

THE GREENLINE
ROOFTOP SETTLEMENT
ZONE 7B - SECTOR 9
13:42 LOCAL

REPORT.

THIS IS NATALIE.

WE HAVE
CONFIRMATION.

SCOUT ROUTE
DELTA-SIX.

NO CONTACT.
NO TRAPS.
NO TRACKERS.

BUT WE FOUND
SOMETHING
BETTER.

OLD CITY - UNDERWORKS ACCESS
GRID 7B-9 / DELTA ROUTE

EXTRACTION
POINT
COORDINATES

X: 73.991
Y: 22.617

UNDERWORKS
SERVICE TUNNEL.
ABANDONED.
UNMONITORED.
UNGUARDED.

FIVE CLICKS OUT.
DIRECT SHOT
TO THE INNER HALLS.

HM.

SOUNDS LIKE
FORTUNE'S FINALLY
STOPPED HOLDING
HER BREATH.

NO SIGNS OF
RESISTANCE.

NO GUARDS.

NO POWER
SIGNATURES.

IT'S BEEN
LIKE THAT
FOR WEEKS.

MAYBE
MONTHS.

THEN WE
MOVE WHEN
THE RAIN
CLEARS.

TOMORROW
NIGHT.

I'LL
MARK THE
PATH.

RAFE.
ONE MORE
THING.

THIS ISN'T
A RAID.

IT'S A GHOST
WALK HOME.



WE ARE
PACKING THE
ENTIRE SETTLEMENT
AND MOVING TO
THE ISLAND.

CLEAN WATER.
FRESH SOIL.
A FUTURE.

THAT IS
THE DECISION.



WE LEAVE
TOGETHER.

WE
BUILD
TOGETHER.



WE
DON'T
LEAVE
ANYONE
BEHIND.



WE HAVE
SURVIVED
THE CITY.

NOW WE
CHOOSE
SOMETHING
BETTER.

THE ISLAND
AWAITS.

UNDERWORKS

DEPTH: LEVEL 7
MAINTENANCE CORRIDOR 12B



--KZZT--

THIS IS
HENRA.

--KZZT--

THE SOUTH
VENT GRID IS
COMPROMISED.

WE CAN'T HOLD
THE UPPER CATWALKS.

FALL BACK TO
INNER RING.

--KZZT--

I'M SORRY.

--KZZT--

UNDERSTOOD.
WE'LL STAY IN
RANGE AS LONG
AS WE CAN.

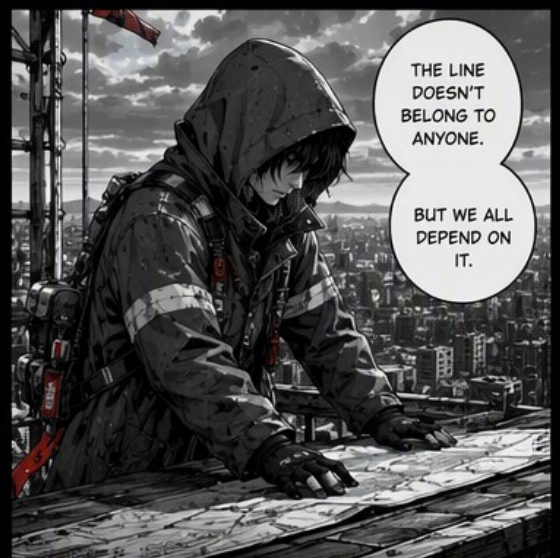
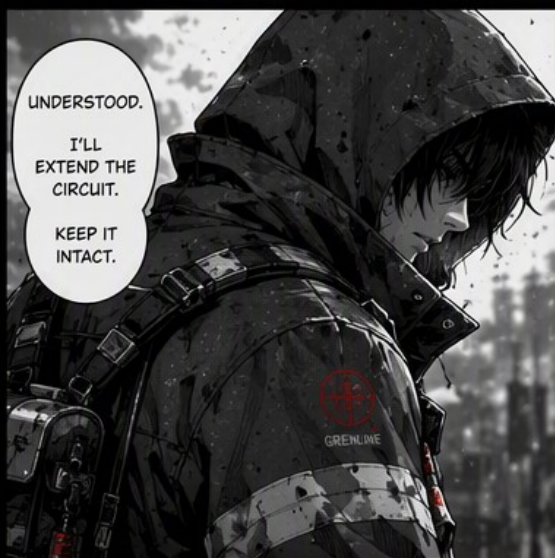


BE
SAFE,
BOTH OF
YOU.

WE
DON'T
GET TO
SAVE
EVERYONE.
BUT WE
CAN TRY.
THAT HAS
TO BE
ENOUGH.

HENRA
OUT.

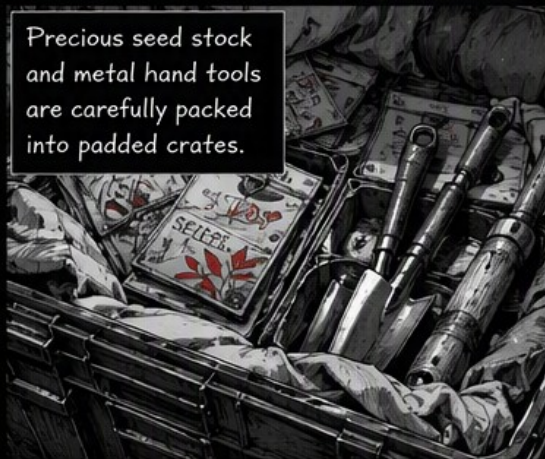
--KZZT--



Across the bustling Greenline rooftop settlement, the community sorts what they can carry from what must stay behind.



Precious seed stock and metal hand tools are carefully packed into padded crates.



A child's chalk drawing on a concrete parapet is left untouched.



A rusted chair is cast aside.



Pip.
11 years old.
138 cm tall.
Quick hands.
Quiet eyes.
Always near
Mira.



Pip carefully wraps
a small polished
stone token...



...and tucks it
into a handmade
travel pouch.



Are you
ready,
Pip?



Ready
when you
are.

GREENLINE

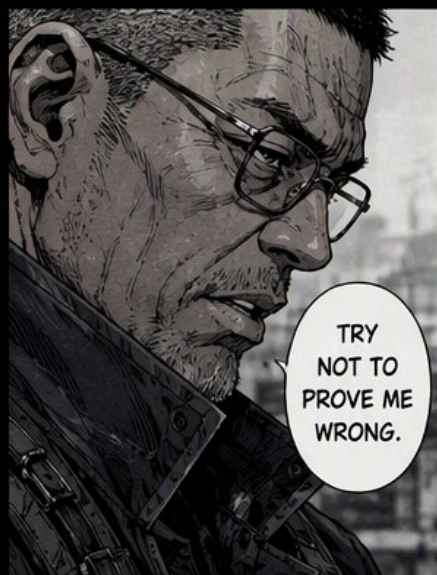
ROOFTOP CARGO DECK
DAY 238 OF RELOCATION



UNDERWORKS
LOGISTICS DIVISION



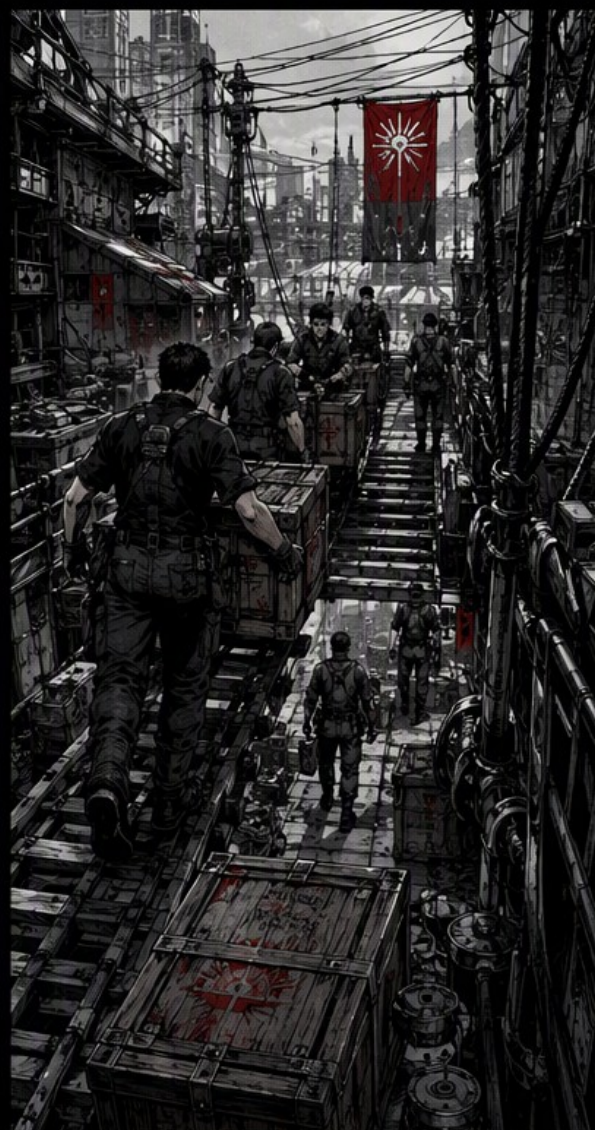
WE HAVE
ENOUGH
TO MOVE.



TRY
NOT TO
PROVE ME
WRONG.



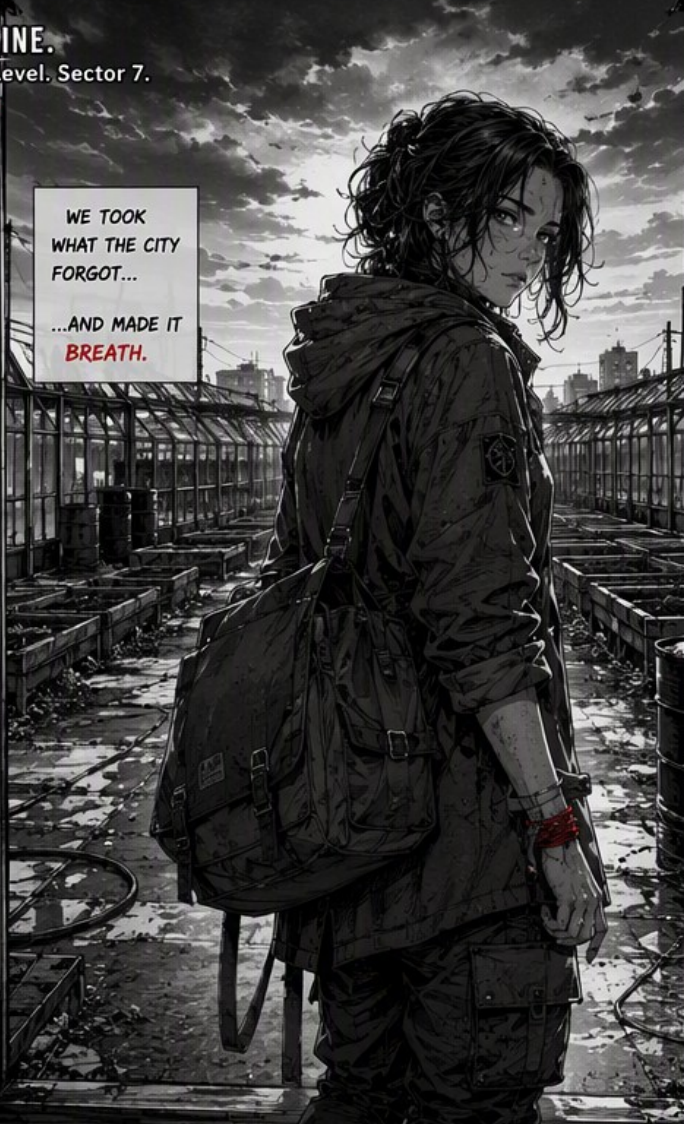
從
屬
工
業



GREENLINE.

Rooftop Level, Sector 7.

02.17.24



WE TOOK
WHAT THE CITY
FORGOT...

...AND MADE IT
BREATH.



THEY
CALLED IT
A **WASTE.**



WE CALLED
IT **HOME.**



SOME
THINGS
DON'T
TRAVEL
LIGHT.



BUT THEY
REMAIN.



ONE
BREATH.



THEN
MOVE.



GREENLINE
WAS HERE

WE
STILL
ARE.



THE CITY
DOESN'T
FORGET.
IT WAITS.

LATITUDE LINE
TRANSIT CORRIDOR
GREENLINE COMMUNITY
MIGRATION



MIRA.

WE MOVE
FORWARD.
TOGETHER.



NATALIE.

I'LL
KEEP
THE FLANK
CLEAN.



YOU
DON'T
HAVE TO DO
THIS ALONE.

I'VE GOT
EYES IN
THE LINE.



I KNOW
WHAT I SIGNED
UP FOR.

SOMEONE
HAS TO
WATCH US
SURVIVE.



THEN WATCH
WELL.

WE ALL
DEPEND ON
YOU.



WE LEAVE
WHAT KILLED
GREENLINE...

...TO FIND
WHAT'S LEFT
OF THE WORLD.

DESTINATION:
THE LAKE REGION
DISTANCE:
APPROX. 240 KM
ETA:
UNKNOWN
MISSION:
SURVIVAL.
REBUILD.
REMEMBER.



WE ENDURE. WE REMEMBER. WE REBUILD. GL

GREENLINE EXODUS

DAY 7 OF THE CROSSING.
THE OLD CAUSEWAY.

THE FULL GREENLINE
REFUGEE COLUMN
CROSSES IN ORDER.

NO ONE FALLS BEHIND.

HENRA WALKS
WITH PATIENCE.

RAFE SCOUTS
AHEAD.

BOTH WATCH
THE SHORELINE.

PINE. BIRCH.
WEATHERED COTTAGES.

A PLACE THAT
REMEMBERED PEOPLE.

LOOKS QUIET.

TOO QUIET.

QUIET IS
A KIND OF
TRAP.

THEN WE
WATCH HARDER.

THREE KILOMETERS.

THE LONG WALK ENDS
WHEN THE REAL ONE
BEGINS.

3KM

GREENLINE
ISLAND



WE'RE NOT JUST
SURVIVING HERE.
WE'RE PUTTING
ROOTS DOWN.

THIS PLACE
WILL BREATHE
AGAIN.

GREENLINE VILLAGE
LAKE ELLIS, CASCADES



THE WATER
HERE IS SO
CLEAR...

...LIKE IT
REMEMBERS
SOMETHING
OLD.

PIP
AGE: 11
SCOUT IN TRAINING
NATURALIST



SOUTH RIDGE
IS QUIET.

TOO QUIET.

NATALIE
AGE: 24
RECON SPECIALIST
PERIMETER SECURITY



QUIET
USUALLY
MEANS
WATCHING.



KEEP YOUR
FRIENDS CLOSE
AND YOUR
SENSES
CLOSER.



YOU THINK
SOMEONE'S
OUT THERE?

I THINK
SOMEONE
ALWAYS IS.



WE'LL BUILD.
WE'LL GROW.
WE'LL DEFEND.

THIS ISN'T
JUST A PLACE
TO HIDE.

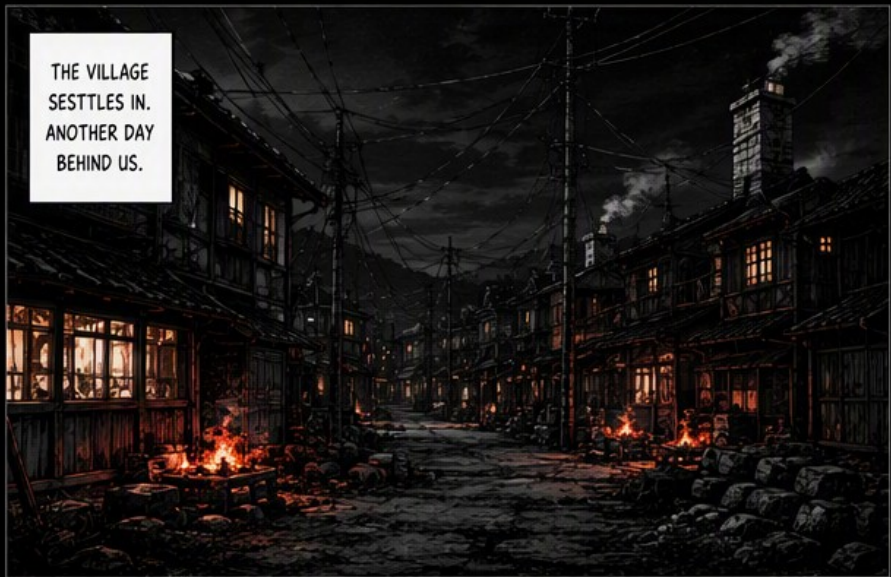
IT'S A FUTURE
WORTH FIGHTING
FOR.





THE BRIDGE
TO THE
MAINLAND.

EMPTY
AS PROMISES
LEFT
UNSPOKEN.

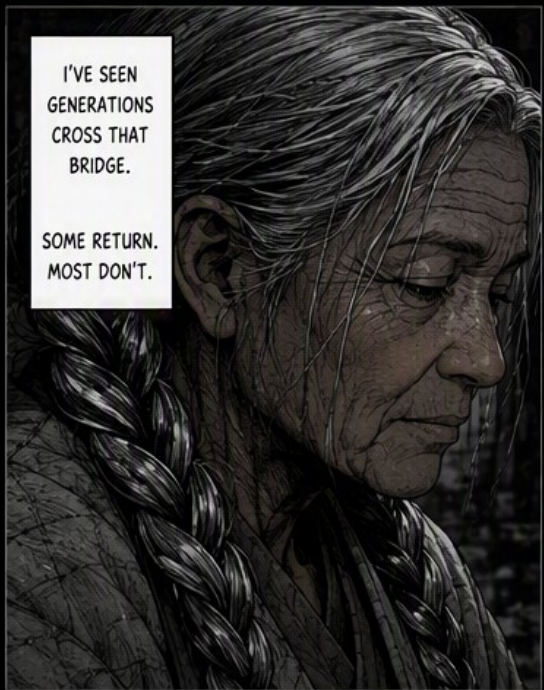


THE VILLAGE
SETTLES IN.
ANOTHER DAY
BEHIND US.



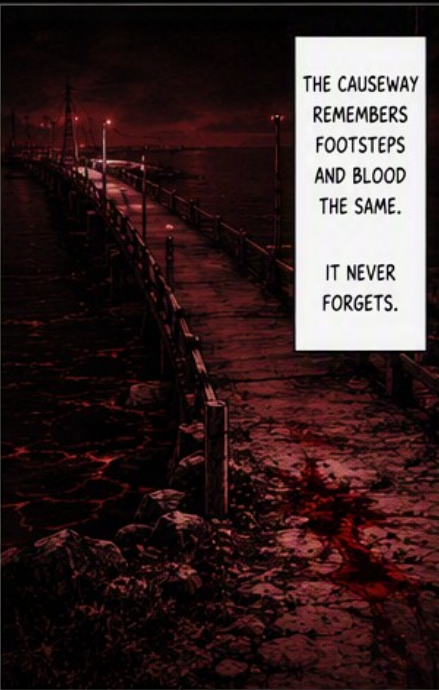
HENRA.
SIXTY-FOUR
YEARS.

SAGE OF
THE ISLAND
BY NEED,
NOT TITLE.



I'VE SEEN
GENERATIONS
CROSS THAT
BRIDGE.

SOME RETURN.
MOST DON'T.



THE CAUSEWAY
REMEMBERS
FOOTSTEPS
AND BLOOD
THE SAME.

IT NEVER
FORGETS.



TAP
-TAP
TAP



NEITHER
DO I.

THREE DAYS
AFTER SETTLING
THE ISLAND.

SHORELINE RECON
NEAR THE BRIDGE
TERMINUS.



WATER
LEVEL'S
UP.

MEANS
MORE RAIN
THAN WE
THOUGHT.



BRIDGE IS
STABLE.
FOR NOW.



NO
FOOTPRINTS.
NO FIRE
SCARS.

NO ONE
HAS BEEN
THROUGH
HERE.



NOT
NO ONE.

JUST...
NOT
RECENTLY.



THREE WEEKS.
MAYBE MORE.



WHATEVER CAME
HERE DIDN'T STAY
LONG.



KEEP
MOVING.

STAY
SHARP.



WE MAP.
WE MARK.

WE DON'T
BELONG
HERE.



THE ISLAND
IS HOME.

THIS IS
JUST...
A GHOST
STORY.





LAKE'S EDGE
SECTOR 7-3
POPULATION:
ZERO.



INTACT.
TOO
INTACT.



PEOPLE
DON'T JUST
DISAPPEAR.



SOMETHING
WIPE THIS
PLACE CLEAN.



NO BODIES.
NO BLOOD.
NO STRUGGLE.
JUST...

ABSENCE.



**IT
HAPPENED
HERE.**



**MOM?
DAD?
WHERE
ARE YOU?**



**WE'RE
STILL
HERE.**



RAFE.
NATALIE.
TWO
O'CLOCK.



ON IT.



ALREADY
CHECKING.

GREYLAKE WATER-TREATMENT PLANT

POP. 14,782 (2010)

EST. 1946

ABANDONED 2014



IT'S IN
BETTER SHAPE
THAN I
EXPECTED.

BUILT
LIKE A
FORTRESS.

THIS COULD
SUPPLY HALF
THE REGION.

IF WE CAN
PURIFY IT.

IF WE CAN
DEFEND IT.

LOOK AT THE
INTAKE PIPES.
THOSE GO DEEP.

CLEANER WATER
THAN ANYTHING
UPSTREAM.

FILTRATION,
STORAGE, PUMPS.
ELEVATED DELIVERY.

IT'S A COMPLETE
SYSTEM.

WE COULD
SUSTAIN A CITY
HERE.

IT'S NOT
JUST WATER.

IT'S POWER.
INFRASTRUCTURE.
CONTROL.

EVERYTHING.

PEOPLE
WOULD KILL
FOR THIS.

WE TAKE IT,
WE PAINT A **TARGET**
ON EVERY MAP
THERE IS.

THEN WE
DECIDE WHO
GETS TO
FIND US.

**NOT THE
OTHER WAY
AROUND.**

GREENLINE: UNDERWORKS
CHAPTER 34: DRY WELLS
OLD SOUTH WATER-TREATMENT PLANT

OLD SOUTH
WATER-TREATMENT
PLANT

BUILT: 1959
ABANDONED: 2011

RAFE. NATALIE. MIRA.
UNDERWORKS RECON UNIT.
GREENLINE CONTRACT.
OBJECTIVE: INFRASTRUCTURE ASSESSMENT.

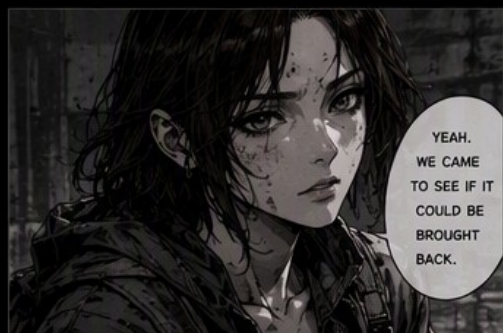


DOORS HELD.
GOOD. LET'S
MOVE.

PUMPING STATION B



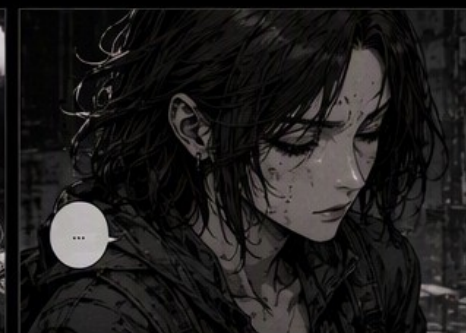
POWER'S
DEAD. ZERO
SIGNAL.
THIS PLACE
IS A CORPSE.



YEAH.
WE CAME
TO SEE IF IT
COULD BE
BROUGHT
BACK.



AND?



...

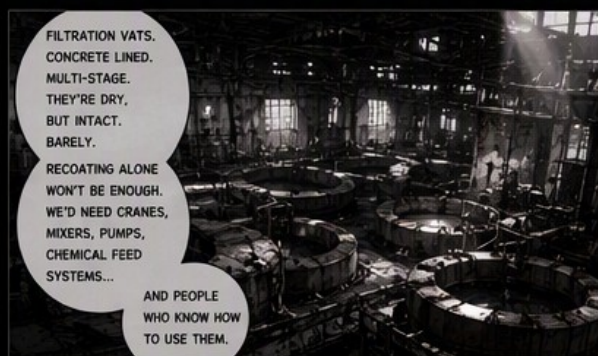


MAIN PUMP ARRAY.
CENTRIFUGAL.
MODEL 9H-3200.
DISCONTINUED
THIRTY YEARS
AGO.

THE CASINGS
ARE FROZEN.
SEALS ARE
CRACKED. SHAFTS
ARE SCARRED.
DRIVE COUPLINGS
ARE LOCKED.

THIS PLANT
WAS DESIGNED
FOR CONTINUOUS
MUNICIPAL
OPERATION.

NOT SMALL-SCALE
IRRIGATION.
NOT WITHOUT
HEAVY MACHINERY.
AND A GRID
CONNECTION.



FILTRATION VATS.
CONCRETE LINED.
MULTI-STAGE.
THEY'RE DRY,
BUT INTACT.
BARELY.

RECOATING ALONE
WON'T BE ENOUGH.
WE'D NEED CRANES,
MIXERS, PUMPS,
CHEMICAL FEED
SYSTEMS...

AND PEOPLE
WHO KNOW HOW
TO USE THEM.



SO,
IN SHORT...



RESTORING
THIS PLACE
IS BEYOND
GREENLINE'S
CURRENT
CAPACITY.

IT WOULD
TAKE YEARS.
AND MORE
THAN WE
HAVE.



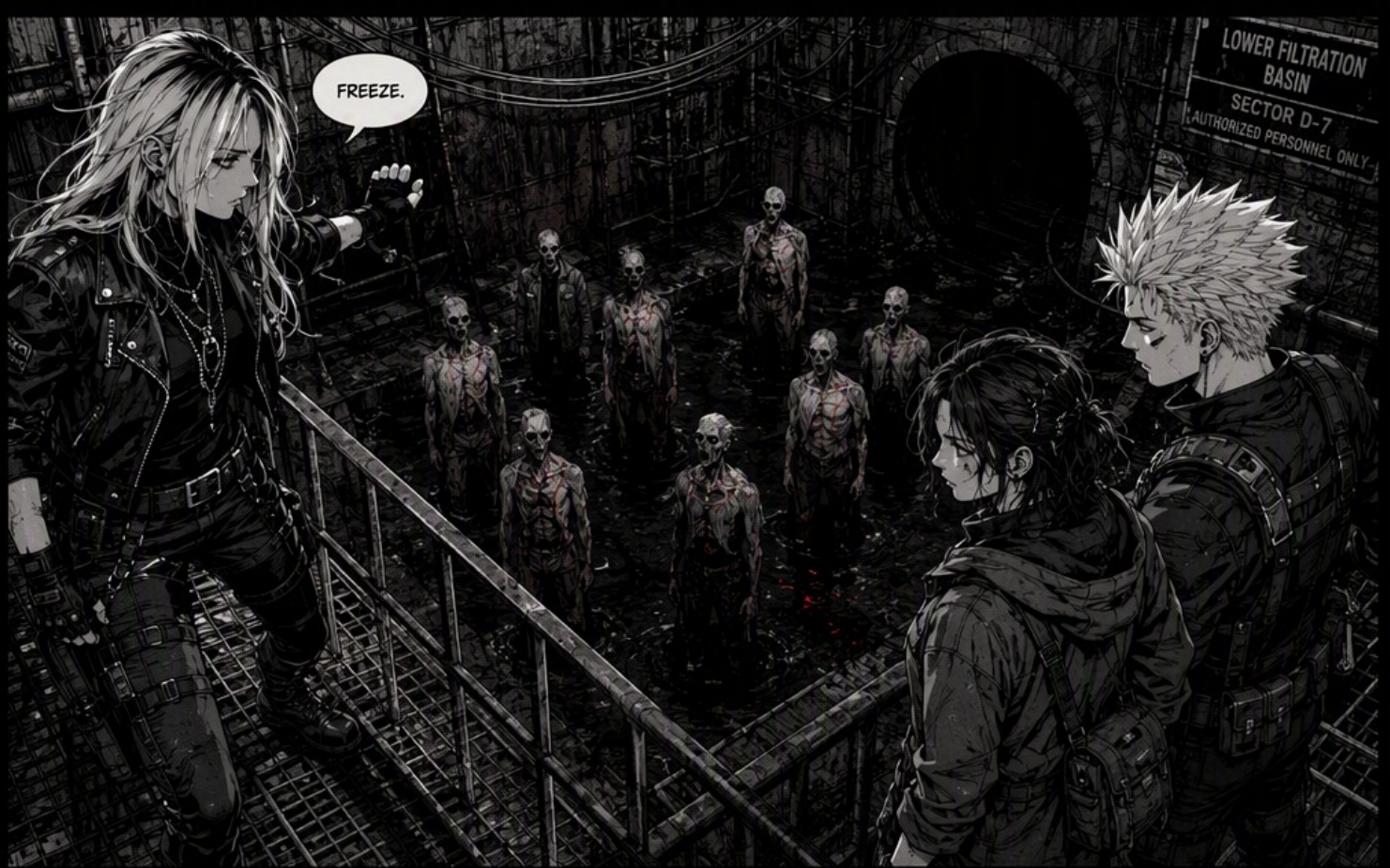
FIGURES.
STILL...
WORTH
KNOWING.



KNOWLEDGE
IS ASSET.
EVEN IF WE
CAN'T USE IT
YET.



LET'S
MAP WHAT
WE CAN.
MOVE.



THE HOLLOW.

DORMANT...

...UNTIL
THEY
AREN'T.

ERRATIC.
UNPREDICTABLE.
UNRELENTING.



NATALIE.
RECON SPECIALIST.

OBSERVE.
ASSESS.
SIGNAL.
SURVIVE.



MIRA.
FIELD OPERATIVE.

EMPATHY.
RESOLVE.
PURPOSE.
PROTECT.



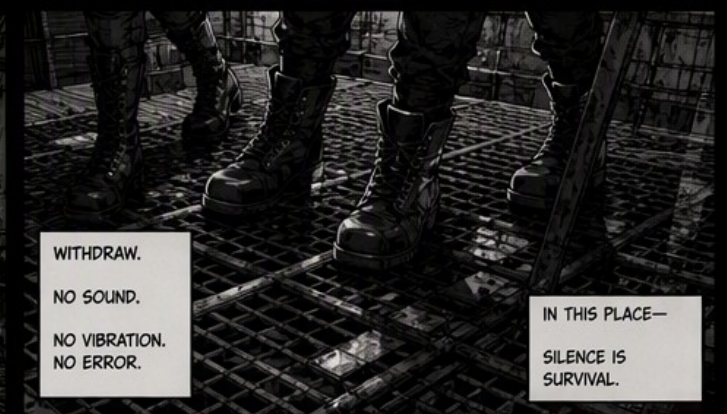
RAFE.
FIELD SCOUT.

SWIFT.
FOCUSED.
LETHAL.
ESSENTIAL.



CONFIRMED:
VAST UNDERGROUND
NETWORK.

UNKNOWN DEPTH.
UNLIMITED RISK.



WITHDRAW.
NO SOUND.
NO VIBRATION.
NO ERROR.

IN THIS PLACE—
SILENCE IS
SURVIVAL.

KRRRNCHH

LOWER PIPE
GALLERY.
SECTOR C.
WATER PLANT.
DEPTH: -92m

EIGHT DORMANT
THE HOLLOW.
INFECTED.
HUMAN.
HOSTILE.
ALL OF THEM.
NOW AWAKE.

NO WORDS.
NO WARNINGS.
ONLY MOVEMENT.

SURVIVAL IS
A LANGUAGE
WE SPEAK
FLUENTLY.

SHHK

NATALIE.
TWIN TRENCH BLADES.
CERVICAL TARGETS.
DISABLE. SILENT.
FINAL.

RAFE.
LEVERAGE.
PIN. CONTROL.
TERMINATE.

MIRA.
REINFORCED PRY-CLUB.
STRUCTURAL.
EFFECTIVE.
UNSENTIMENTAL.

INTERLOCKING
DEFENSIVE RING.
FOUR SCOUTS.
EIGHT HOSTILES.

RESULT:
ZERO CASUALTIES.
ONE HUNDRED
PERCENT
EFFICIENCY.

THAT'S
UNDERWORKS.

ANOTHER DAY
IN THE DARK.
ANOTHER
MISSION
COMPLETED.

WE MOVE
FORWARD.
ALWAYS.



HOME IS WHERE WE
KEEP EACH OTHER ALIVE.

LAKESTONE ISLAND — COMMUNITY CLEARING
NIGHT

DISCOVERY LOG — 042

DATE: 07-15

SUBJECT: WATER-TREATMENT PLANT

STATUS: LOGGED

RECORDED BY: MIRA



THE INTAKE
SITS JUST OFFSHORE.
THREE MAIN PIPES RUN
UNDER THE RIDGE —
TWO FEED FILTRATION,
ONE BYPASSES TO
RESERVOIR.

ALL OF IT LEADS
TO THE PLANT HERE.
OLD INDUSTRIAL FOOTPRINT.
HEAVY, BUT FUNCTIONAL.

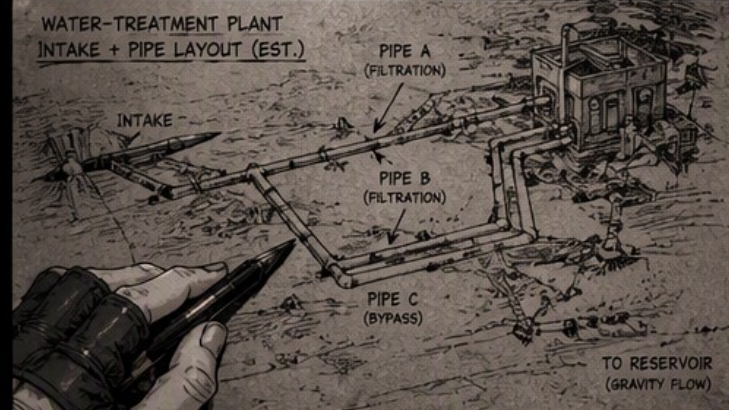


MM.

I KNOW THE
LAY OF THAT
GROUND.
BUILT BEFORE
YOUR FATHER
WAS BORN.



WATER-TREATMENT PLANT
INTAKE + PIPE LAYOUT (EST.)



THEN THAT'S
WORTH A
PROPER LOOK.

LATER —
NOT TONIGHT.

THE NIGHT
IS FOR REST.
NOT RISK.

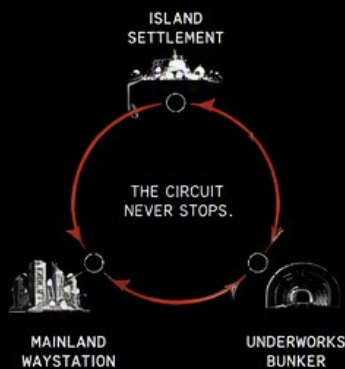


WE'LL LOG IT.
FOR TOMORROW.
FOR ALL OF US.



THE SIGNAL RUNNER

ANONYMOUS COURIER OPERATIVE
CONNECTING THE ISLAND SETTLEMENT,
THE MAINLAND WAYSTATION,
AND THE UNDERWORKS BUNKER.



DISTANCE IS SURVIVAL.
SILENCE IS PROTECTION.
THE CIRCUIT IS LIFE.



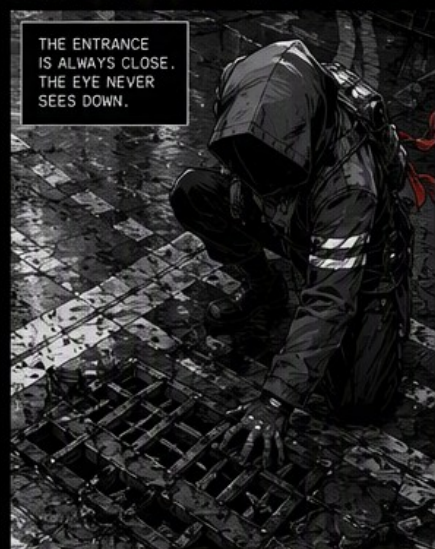
MARK THE PATH.
LEAVE NOTHING
BUT SIGNS.



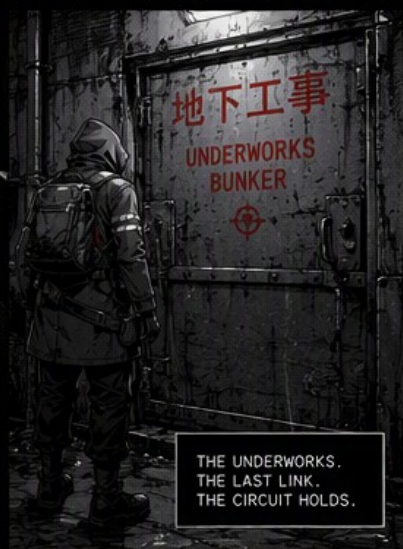
THE HOLLOW HUNT IN PACKS.
THEY SEE MOVEMENT.
THEY FEEL SOUND.
THEY ARE PATIENCE MADE FLESH.



NOT DEAD.
NOT ALIVE.
SOMETHING
BETWEEN.



THE ENTRANCE
IS ALWAYS CLOSE.
THE EYE NEVER
SEES DOWN.



THE UNDERWORKS.
THE LAST LINK.
THE CIRCUIT HOLDS.

ISLAND SETTLEMENT

MAINLAND WAYSTATION

UNDERWORKS BUNKER

POPULATION: 327
STATUS: HOLDING

POPULATION: 1,842
STATUS: PRECARIOUS

POPULATION: 616
STATUS: STABLE



UNDERWORKS COMPLEX.
MAIN MAINTENANCE READY-ROOM.

A DISPATCH
FROM MIRA.

THANK YOU.
THE SIGNAL
WAS CLEAN?

MAINLAND WATER PLANT COORDINATES

GRID REF.
N 37.7749°
W 122.4194°
ELEV. -216M
DEPTH: 812M

CLEAN.
MIRA SAID
IT'S URGENT.

WATER PLANT,
HMM? FINALLY
SOMETHING
ON THE
MAINLAND.

DEEP. HEAVILY.
DEFENDED. BUT
IT'S OUR BEST
SHOT YET.

MIRA SAYS
THE INTAKE
TUNNELS
ARE STILL
INTACT.

WE CAN
GET IN
BELOW
THE FILTER
ARRAY.

IF WE MOVE
QUIET, WE
CAN SHUT
IT DOWN.

RISK IS HIGH.
REWARD IS
HIGHER.

WE PLAN.
WE PREP.
WE DON'T
RUSH.

I CAN
SCOUT THE
OLD ACCESS
ROUTES.

THERE'S A
SERVICE
SHAFT NEAR
THE RIDGE
LINE...

I REMEMBER
SOMETHING
FROM THE OLD
SURVEYS.



PUMP VAULT B-17.
DEEP BEDROCK WELL.

THE QUARTERMASTER
DROPS A REAGENT
TABLET INTO THE
SAMPLE VIAL.

THE WATER
INSTANTLY
CLOUDS.

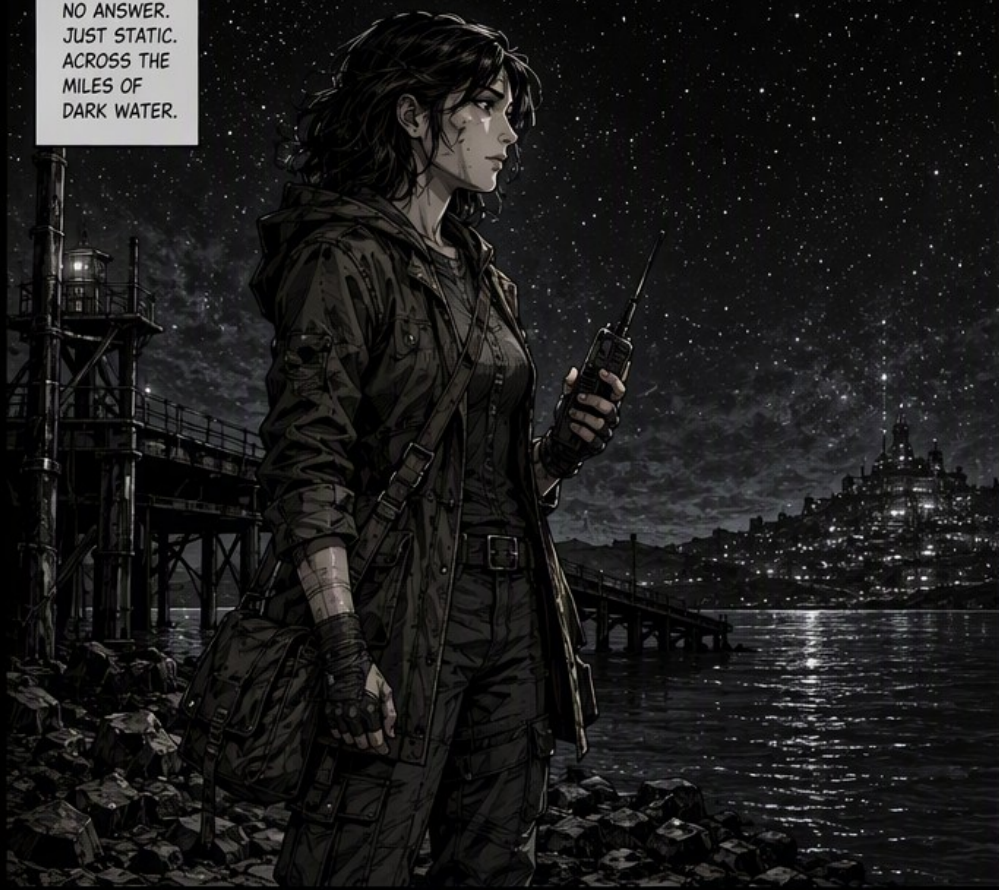
A MURKY,
UNNATURAL
BLACK.

OUR WELL.
OUR LIFE.
POISONED.

WE ARE
RUNNING OUT
OF TIME.



NO ANSWER.
JUST STATIC.
ACROSS THE
MILES OF
DARK WATER.



... ..
... ..



SOME
BONDS
DON'T
NEED
WORDS.



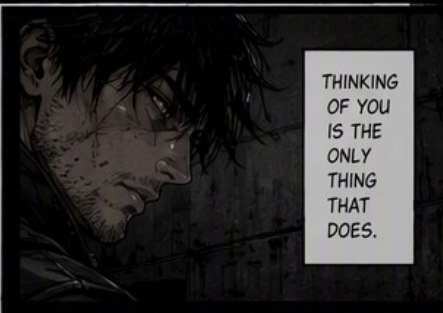
I'LL
KEEP
WATCH.

DOWN
HERE,
TIME
DOESN'T
MOVE.

IT
JUST
ECHOES.



THINKING
OF YOU
IS THE
ONLY
THING
THAT
DOES.



SAME SKY.
DIFFERENT
GROUND.

SAME
SILENCE.
SAME
LONGING.

ALWAYS.

UNTIL THE
DISTANCE
BREAKS.
I'LL BE
WAITING.

